Relative clauses

Relative clauses tell us more about people and things. There are two types:

1. We use relative clauses to make clear which person or thing we are talking about:

He is the actor **who** plays in the new Harry Potter film.
This is the book **which** I wrote.

In this kind of relative clause, we can use **that** instead of **who** or **which:**

He is the actor **that** plays in the new Harry Potter film.
This is the book **that** I wrote.

We can **leave out** the pronoun **if it is the object** of the relative clause:

This is the book **that** I wrote. (that is the object of wrote) = This is the book I wrote.

The relative pronoun is the subject/object of the relative clause, so we do not repeat the subject/object:

He is the man **who** wanted to date me years ago. (who ~~he~~ wanted)

This is the picture **that** my daughter painted. (that my daughter painted ~~it~~)

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2. We use relative clauses to give more information about a person, thing or situation.

My grandfather, **who is 75**, decided to run a marathon.

We took a walk in the city centre, **which I always enjoy**.

With this kind of relative clause, we use commas (,) to separate it from the rest of the sentence.

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